

Mystery Challenge – Developer Specification

Overview

The **Mystery Challenge** is a visual puzzle round where teams solve a sequence of connected clues to uncover a hidden story.

Unlike a normal picture round where each question is independent, every answer contributes to a larger narrative.

By the end of the round, teams should be able to explain what happened in the story.

Player Experience

What contestants see

For each puzzle:

1. An image appears.
2. A clue is displayed.
3. A scrambled word is shown.
4. Teams have limited time to solve it.
5. Correct answer is revealed.
6. Story advances.
7. Next puzzle appears.

After Puzzle 10:

- All solved words are displayed in order.
 - Final story reveal is shown.
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Round Flow

Opening Animation

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Puzzle 1

↓

Puzzle 2

↓

Puzzle 3

↓

...

↓

Puzzle 10



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Final Reveal

Time Structure

Activity	Time
Opening Animation	30 sec
Each Puzzle	20 sec
10 Puzzles	200 sec
Final Reveal	20 sec
Total	~4 mins

Puzzle Data Structure

Each puzzle contains:

JSON

UI Layout

```
|  
| IMAGE |  
|  
-----  
  
CLUE:  
  
The weakest part of any system
```

SCRAMBLED:

KNLI

TIME:

15

After timer expires:

ANSWER:

LINK



STORY:

Investigators discovered a weak link
in the school's safety system.

Scenario 1: THE SILENT WARNING

Opening

At 8:15 AM, students arrived at Crescent Academy.

Everything appeared normal.

At 10:30 AM, a teacher noticed something unusual.

The school was not under attack yet.

But all the signs suggested that something dangerous was about to happen.

The teams have 3 minutes to uncover the threat.

Puzzle 1

Picture:

Broken chain link

Clue:

The weakest part of any system.

Scrambled:

KNLI

Answer:

LINK

Story:

Investigators discovered a weak link in the school's safety system.

Puzzle 2

Picture:

Shadow inside restricted area

Clue:

A person present where they are not authorized.

Scrambled:

RTUINRDE

Answer:

INTRUDER

Story:

Security footage revealed a possible intruder.

Puzzle 3

Picture:

School map with circled area

Clue:

A place selected for special attention.

Scrambled:

RAGTTE

Answer:

TARGET

Story:

The intruder appeared interested in a specific target.

Puzzle 4

Picture:

Multiple clocks

Clue:

Choosing the perfect moment.

Scrambled:

GMNITI

Answer:

TIMING

Story:

Whoever planned this understood timing perfectly.

Puzzle 5

Picture:

Suspicious text message

Clue:

Information passed secretly.

Scrambled:

SGAESME

Answer:

MESSAGE

Story:

A coded message was discovered.

Puzzle 6

Picture:

Investigation board

Clue:

Careful examination to discover the truth.

Scrambled:

YAANLSIS

Answer:

ANALYSIS

Story:

The analysis revealed a disturbing pattern.

Puzzle 7

Picture:

CCTV monitoring room

Clue:

Continuous observation.

Scrambled:

NIMTOROING

Answer:

MONITORING

Story:

Monitoring showed unusual movement around the campus.

Puzzle 8

Picture:

Emergency beacon

Clue:

A signal demanding immediate action.

Scrambled:

TREAL

Answer:

ALERT

Story:

The school issued an alert.

Puzzle 9

Picture:

Students leaving building

Clue:

Organized movement away from danger.

Scrambled:

AUEVTCAIOON

Answer:

EVACUATION

Story:

A precautionary evacuation began.

Puzzle 10

Picture:

Protective shield around school

Clue:

The final objective of every safety plan.

Scrambled:

NTEITCOPRO

Answer:

PROTECTION

Story:

The school successfully protected everyone.

Final Reveal

LINK

↓

INTRUDER

↓

TARGET

↓

TIMING

↓

MESSAGE



↓
ANALYSIS
↓
MONITORING
↓
ALERT
↓
EVACUATION
↓
PROTECTION

Final Message:

"The evidence revealed an attempted security threat. Through monitoring, analysis, and rapid response, the school prevented a dangerous situation."

Additional Scenarios to Build

The developer should design the system so the same engine can load different mystery packs.

Scenario 2

RISING WATERS

WARNING
PRECIPITATION
OVERFLOW
SHELTER
COMMUNICATION
ROUTE
RESCUE
COOPERATION
EVACUATION
SAFETY



Scenario 3

THE BLACKOUT

DEMAND
GRID
FAILURE
OUTAGE
GENERATOR



REPAIR
RESTORATION
STABILITY
RELIABILITY
POWER

Scenario 4

CYBER ATTACK

PASSWORD
NETWORK
BREACH
VIRUS
DETECTION
ANALYSIS
FIREWALL
RECOVERY
SECURITY
PROTECTION



Scenario 5

THE MISSING EXAM PAPERS

KEY
OFFICE
ACCESS
FOOTPRINT
CAMERA
EVIDENCE
SUSPECT
INVESTIGATION
RECOVERY
JUSTICE



Scoring System

Option A (Recommended)

Each correct answer:

10 points



Total:

$10 \times 10 = 100$ points



Option B (Increasing Difficulty)

Q1 = 5
Q2 = 5
Q3 = 10
Q4 = 10
Q5 = 10
Q6 = 15
Q7 = 15
Q8 = 15
Q9 = 20
Q10 = 25



Total:

130 points



Technical Requirements

Admin Panel

Must allow:

- Create Scenario
- Upload Opening Video
- Upload Puzzle Images
- Enter Clues
- Enter Scrambled Words
- Enter Answers
- Enter Story Text
- Rearrange Puzzle Order

Competition Controls

Moderator can:

- Start Round
 - Pause Timer
 - Reveal Answer
 - Skip Puzzle
 - Trigger Final Reveal
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Future Enhancement

Later versions can support:

- Drag-and-drop puzzle assembly
- Team tablets/mobile submissions
- Live scoreboard
- Sound effects
- Animated story transitions
- AI-generated mystery packs

The key idea is that **students are not merely solving words—they are acting as investigators, gradually uncovering a complete story from connected visual evidence**. This is what makes the Mystery Challenge memorable and different from a standard picture round.